Instructions for the "Mishna LeChok" Calendar

A. The calendar is built to complete all Six Orders of Mishna in one year.

B. This calendar has two kinds of learning each day. Kind A: one chapter of Mishnayos from the fixed order of learning in the holy sefer "**Chok LeYisrael**", founded by the holy Arizal according to Kabbalah, in which on each of the six weekdays one chapter is learned from one of the Six Orders of Mishna in sequence: Sunday from Seder Zeraim, Monday from Seder Moed, and so on until Friday from Seder Taharos. On Shabbos there is no Mishnayos chapter in this order of learning.

C. Since the order above does not complete the Mishnayos within the year, each day adds a second kind of learning: several more mishnayos from the tractates and chapters that are not in the "Chok LeYisrael" order. This added learning is about five mishnayos a day, and it includes Shabbos as well. It is called **"Mishna LeChok"**.

D. In weeks with joined parshiyos there is no learning of the second kind, "**Mishna LeChok**". In its column we put instead the additional Mishnayos chapter of the joined parsha; as mentioned above, on Shabbos there is no such learning. We added a * mark to this learning to show that it is not from the "Mishna LeChok" order that appears in this column the rest of the year, but from the "Chok LeYisrael" order.

E. In years when Shavuos falls on Friday and Shabbos outside Eretz Yisrael, the weekly parsha "Naso" is not read on Shabbos in its order; the reading is that of the second day of Shavuos. The reading of Naso moves to the following week, and so on until Parshas Balak, when outside Eretz Yisrael Chukas and Balak are joined. Since this happens in very few years, the "**Mishna LeChok**" order would continue as usual in that week. The result would be that in the week of Shavuos there is no learning of "Chok LeYisrael" nor of "Mishna LeChok", and afterwards, in the week when "Chukas and Balak" are read, there is a double portion of "Chok LeYisrael" and a double portion of "Mishna LeChok", which is very hard on the learner. Therefore we made a correction in the calendar: in these weeks the order of learning follows the readings of Eretz Yisrael. In the week of Shavuos the learning of Naso is learned, and so on, and in the week when "Chukas and Balak" are read, only the learning of Parshas Balak is learned. The calendar shows the parsha being learned in parentheses, next to the parsha of the week.